

Overclocking, overvolting, PS3 woes, router issues and more

We scour through sos@thinkdigit.com to answer your issues

Overclocking woes

My system specs:

- Gigabyte H61 motherboard
- Kingston 2 GB RAM
- Intel Pentium G630 2.7Ghz
- Stock Supercomp 450W PSU

I contacted you earlier with a choice of card and you suggested me with a HD 6670 GDDR3. So what I got is the HD 6570 GDDR3 which has similar specs.

I searched online regarding overclocking the HD6570 and I found some results where core clock was overclocked to 830MHz. I have the following questions:

1. Can I overclock the HD6570 to the clock speeds of HD6670 and keep it stable enough to play stressful games?
2. The HD6670 GDDR3 is just an over-clocked HD6570. Why buy it then?
3. Can I overclock an HD6670 GDDR3 to a stable 1 GHz core clock?
4. What is over-volting?
5. Some basics about overclocking?

I have no idea of overclocking any GPU or CPU like what's stable temp, what software to use, etc. The only thing I ever over-clocked is Dual Core E2180 to a 2.7GHz.

A You can overclock your card to a certain extent. But you also need to be aware that overclocking a card means that you are increasing the speed at

which the transistors run, in effect it will generate heat. For an entry level card such as HD 6570 it will be a challenge to keep it running for long. It all depends on the system stability and is a trial and error process. You may get your card running at the speeds you want and get a performance improvement, but at the same time you need to be aware of the fact that the specified life of the components is also reducing due to overclocking.

Sure using tools such as MSI Afterburner, you can increase the core clock and memory clock speed. But that is just half the story. After overclocking, you need to ensure that your system is stable by running benchmarks such as 3D Mark 11 or 3D Mark Vantage. A mild overlock can give you better frame rates, but stretching the clock speeds to a level where the card is not able to keep up with the games or repetitive BSODs are signs of a failed overclocking attempt. Over-volting is basically increasing the voltage of your components beyond manufacturer specification. If you are not careful with this, you may end up frying your components. Beware: Overclocking or Over-volting voids warranty. If you have no idea of overclocking, we would request you to read up on Overclocking. We had done a feature in the December 2011 issue on overclocking graphics cards and CPUs, which you may want to refer to. Using the MSI



Rufus

Afterburner tool, you can get a decent boost in frame rates by overclocking your HD6570, but do it in steps depending on the response of the system after running stability benchmarks.

Formatting issues

In the December 2012 issue, you provided a tool for making pen-drive bootable. I used it on an 8GB pendrive. But after formatting the pendrive it shows only 1GB storage. Help!

Prakash Singh

A All you need to do is download rufus from <http://rufus.akeo.ie/> and run it. Select the pendrive in the dropdown menu and select a partition scheme (e.g. NTFS). Make sure that "Create a bootable disk using..." is unchecked. Hit "Start" and your pendrive should be ready as new.

Gaming on Steam

I wanted to ask a question about Steam. In the November 2012 issue you provided the Blacklight Retribution game. I would like to ask that if I don't have a broadband connection, could I still play games on Steam?

I recently tried Blacklight in Steam but it wanted an update of 5 GB. Without it the game doesn't run. I live in a very remote area thus I am unable to get a broadband connection – I use a prepaid mobile network connection on Vodafone with 2 GB allowance. So can I play Blacklight without the update?

Bagish Singh

A Unfortunately, Blacklight Retribution is a multi-player game and can only be played online. Since the time the game was released on Steam, it has received



MSI Afterburner utility